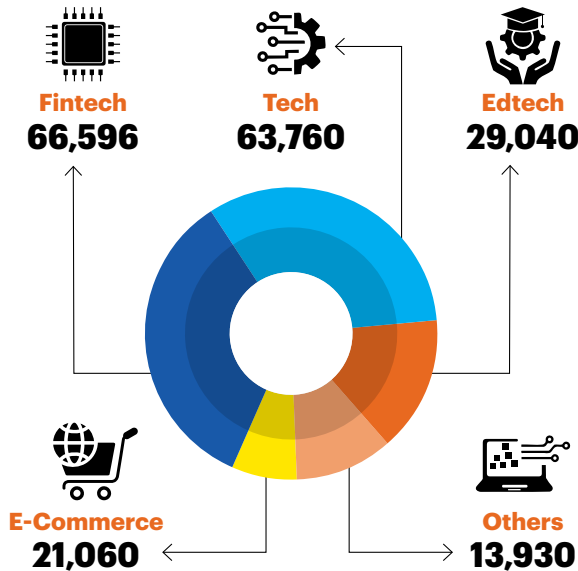


SECTOR BREAKDOWN

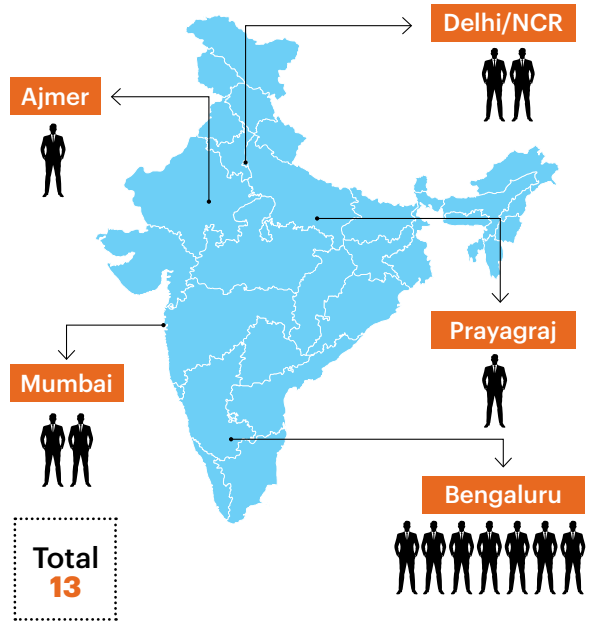
• FINTECH HAS CREATED THE MOST WEALTH, FOLLOWED BY TECH



NOTE FIGURES IN ₹ CRORE

CITY-WISE BREAK UP

• BENGALURU HAS THE LARGEST NUMBER OF SELF-MADE DOLLAR BILLIONAIRES



SOURCE BT RESEARCH, HURUN RESEARCH INSTITUTE

JIO MOMENT AND UPI

In 2016, Reliance Jio launched near-free data and shrunk the cost of a gigabyte to the world's cheapest. Millions of Indians came online for the first time.

Around the same time, the National Payments Corporation of India launched UPI, which enabled instant transfers between two bank accounts with a phone number or a QR code. By the mid-2020s, UPI was clearing tens of billions of transactions a month, more than most other payment systems combined. Cheap data, plus instant payments clubbed with Aadhaar, became India's digital public infrastructure.

VENTURE CAPITAL TURNS BULLISH

None of this would have compounded into billionaire fortunes without a fourth shift, quieter than the others but just as decisive—global venture capital deciding, almost all at once, that India was investable. That changed as smartphone penetration and UPI volumes gave investors hard evidence of user growth and transaction data.

SoftBankVision Fund, Tiger Global, Sequoia's India arm, Accel and a wave of sovereign and pension funds moved in through the mid-to-late 2010s, writing cheques that let founders scale user bases years before worrying about profit. Unlike the patient family

THREE SHIFTS HELPED THE FOUNDERS—INFRASTRUCTURE (UPI, AADHAAR, CHEAP DATA), CAPITAL (A VENTURE ECOSYSTEM THAT FINALLY MATURED), AND TECHNOLOGY

FLIPKART WROTE THE PLAYBOOK—FIND A FRAGMENTED OFFLINE MARKET AND DIGITISE IT WITH THE HELP OF VENTURE CAPITAL FASTER THAN ANY INCUMBENT COULD REACT

GLOBAL VENTURE CAPITAL ALSO FLOODED IN AS SMARTPHONE PENETRATION AND UPI VOLUMES GAVE HARD EVIDENCE OF USER GROWTH AND TRANSACTION DATA